
Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

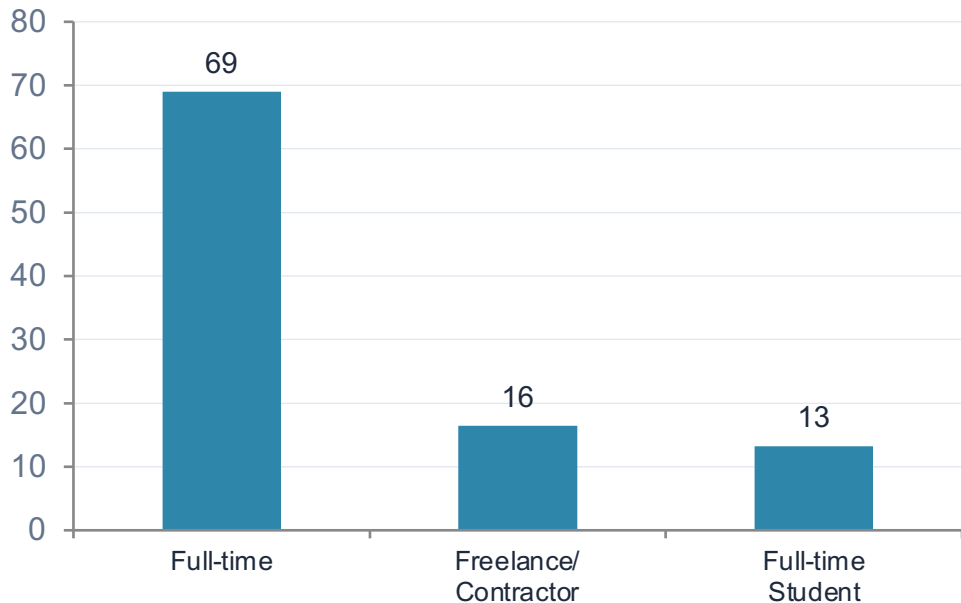
65,437

respondents across 180+ countries

22,677

salary responses (34.7% rate)

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.



-4.2 pp

U.S. full-time employment drop
69% (2023) to 64.8% (2024)

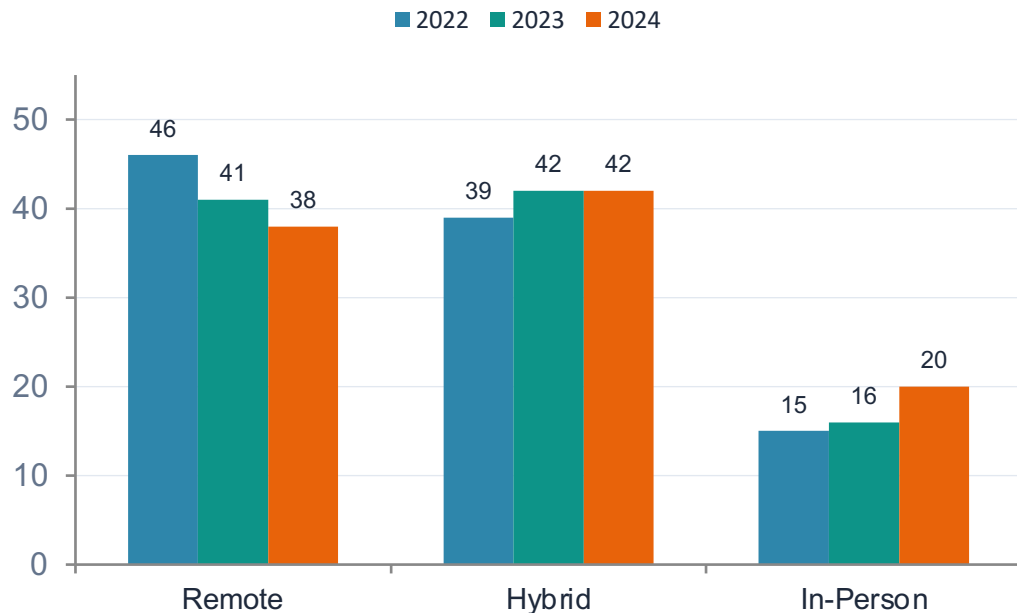
16.4%

Freelance/contracting remains
a significant workforce segment

Regional Split

U.K./Ukraine lean freelance;
Germany/India lean student

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%



+5 pp

In-person work up from 15% to 20% since 2022 (3-year climb)

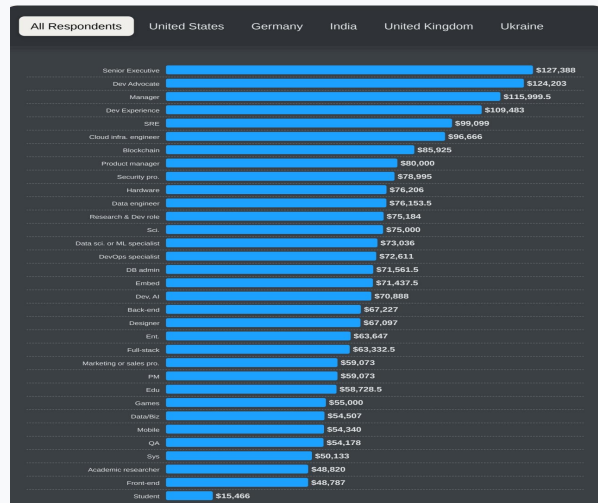
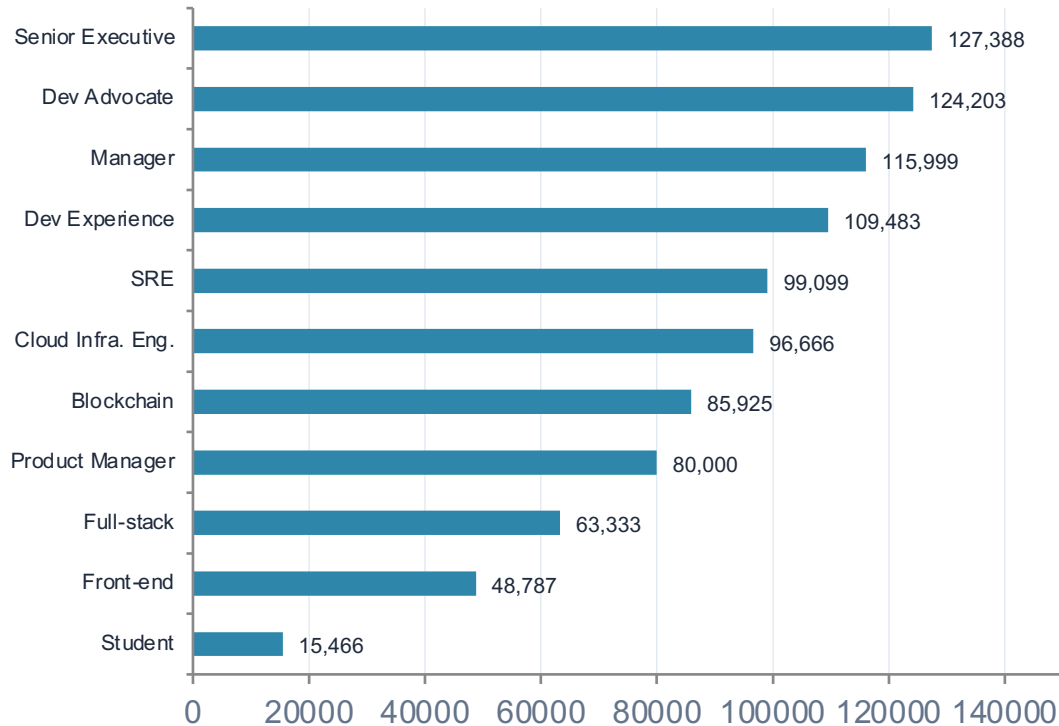
-8 pp

Remote work down from 46% to 38% over the same period

42%

Hybrid remains the dominant arrangement — unchanged since 2023

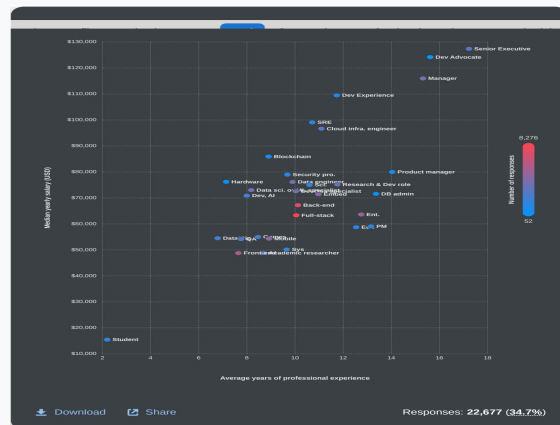
Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary



Key Insight

SRE and Cloud Infra. Engineers are the highest-paid purely technical roles — reflecting the critical importance of keeping digital services running.

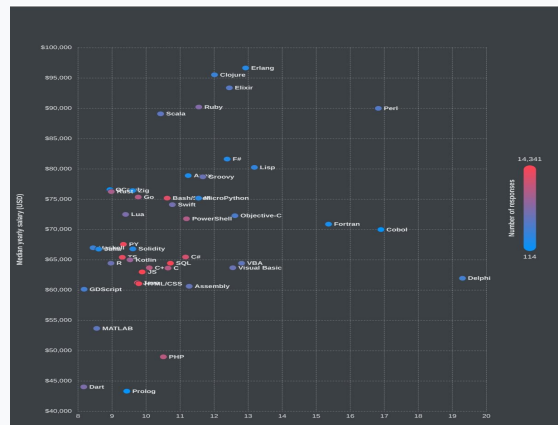
Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



**Senior cluster: 14-17 yrs,
\$116K-\$127K median**

Student outlier: 2 yrs, \$15K

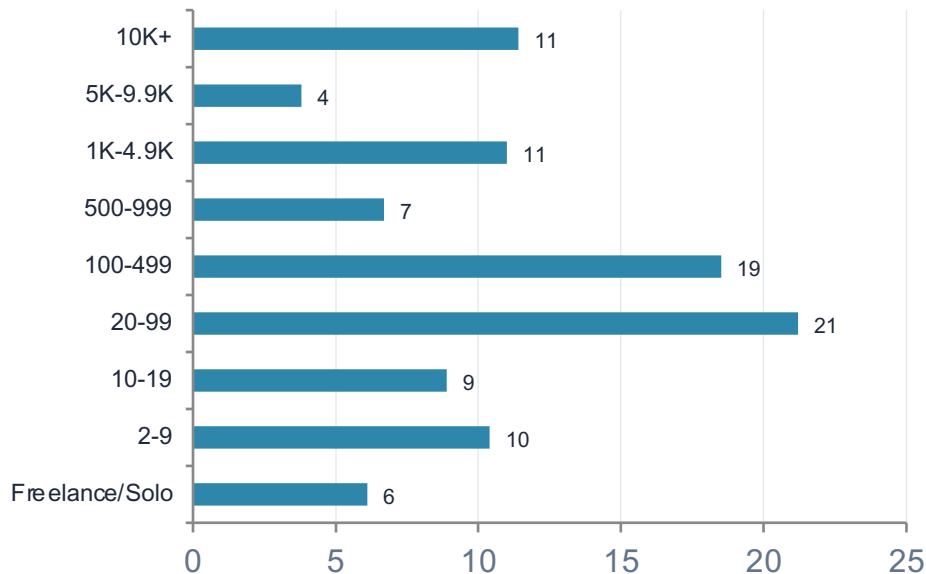
Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K



Top: Erlang \$97K, Clojure \$95K,
Elixir \$93K

~\$10K drop in avg. salary range vs.
2023

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases



47% of developers work at organizations with fewer than 100 employees

62%

of developers influence tech purchases

60%

prefer a build-and-buy approach

Evaluation Methods

75% start a free trial

73% ask other developers

Top influencers: Sr. Execs (99%), Eng. Mgrs (87%), PMs (77%)

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

1

Plan for more contractors

Full-time employment is softening — U.S. full-time dropped 4.2 pp YoY. Build flexibility into workforce planning.

2

Hybrid remains dominant

In-person mandates are growing (20%), but hybrid at 42% is still the norm. Design policies accordingly.

3

DevRel & SRE command premium pay

Senior Executives (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), and SREs (\$99K) top the chart — budget for these roles.

4

Niche languages correlate with higher pay

Erlang, Clojure, Elixir developers earn >\$93K. Language choice in your stack affects talent costs.

5

Engage developers directly

62% influence tech purchases. Vendor strategies should target ICs, not just management.